See Before You Explain

Observation becomes more useful when we distinguish what can be described from what might explain it. Try the sequence before choosing a conclusion.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A person walks toward a doorway, stops, looks right, and turns back. We can name the actions. We cannot tell from the scene why the person turned.

Four questions to carry into practice

01 What could another observer verify?

Write only visible or audible details, not motives.

02 What might explain the action?

List at least two plausible meanings without selecting one as certain.

03 What is missing?

Identify information that could change the interpretation.

04 What is a respectful next question?

Ask openly, or decide that asking is unnecessary.

An observation is not automatically an explanation. This worksheet is educational, not a psychological or clinical assessment.

See Before You Explain — Practice Sheet

Use a fictional or non-identifiable example. Your answers remain on your own sheet; Aetherion does not collect this page.

1. What could another observer verify?

2. What might explain the action?

3. What is missing?

4. What is a respectful next question?